Lukas Voss

15.07.2021

Dynamics of NV centres interacting with background spins

ICQ seminar talk

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Outline

I. The Nitrogen Vacancy & motivation

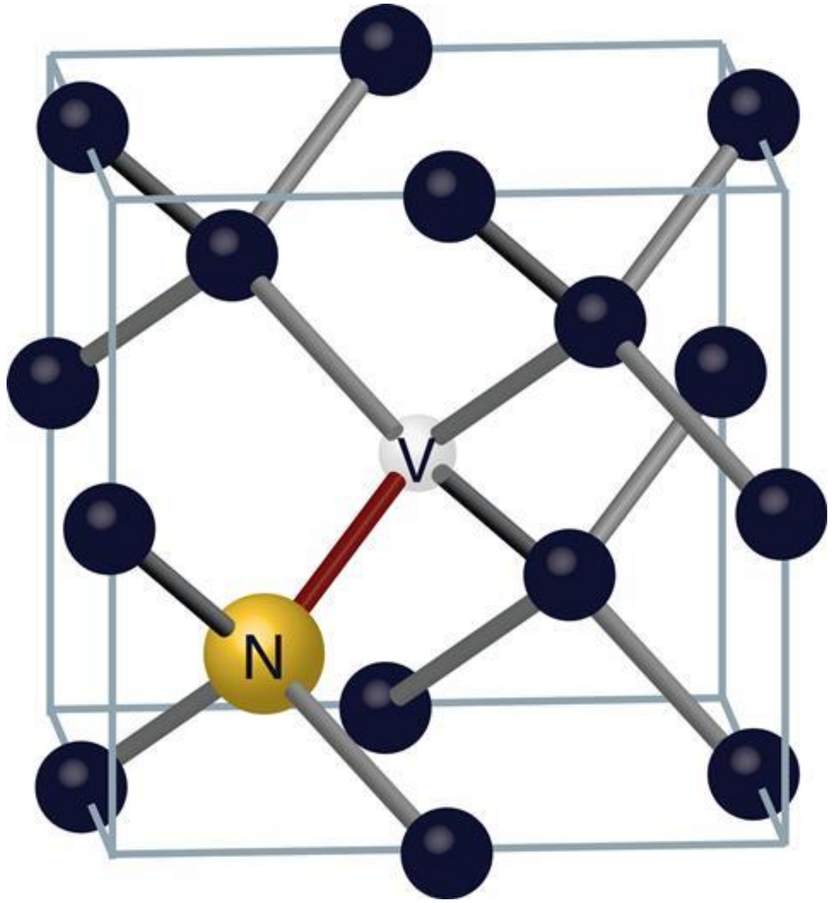
II. The model

III. Summary

IV. Outlook & next steps

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The NV center & motivation



- longest coherence time at room temperature[1]

$(2{,}43 \pm 0{,}06)$ ms

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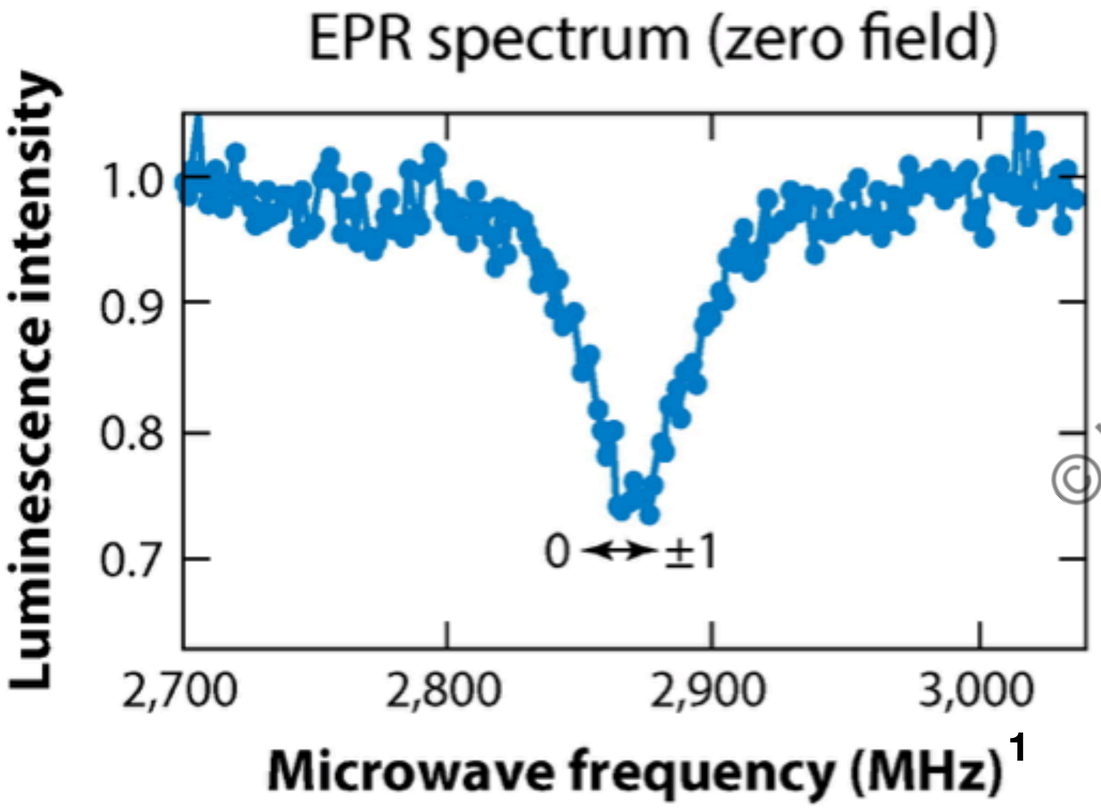
→ single photon source

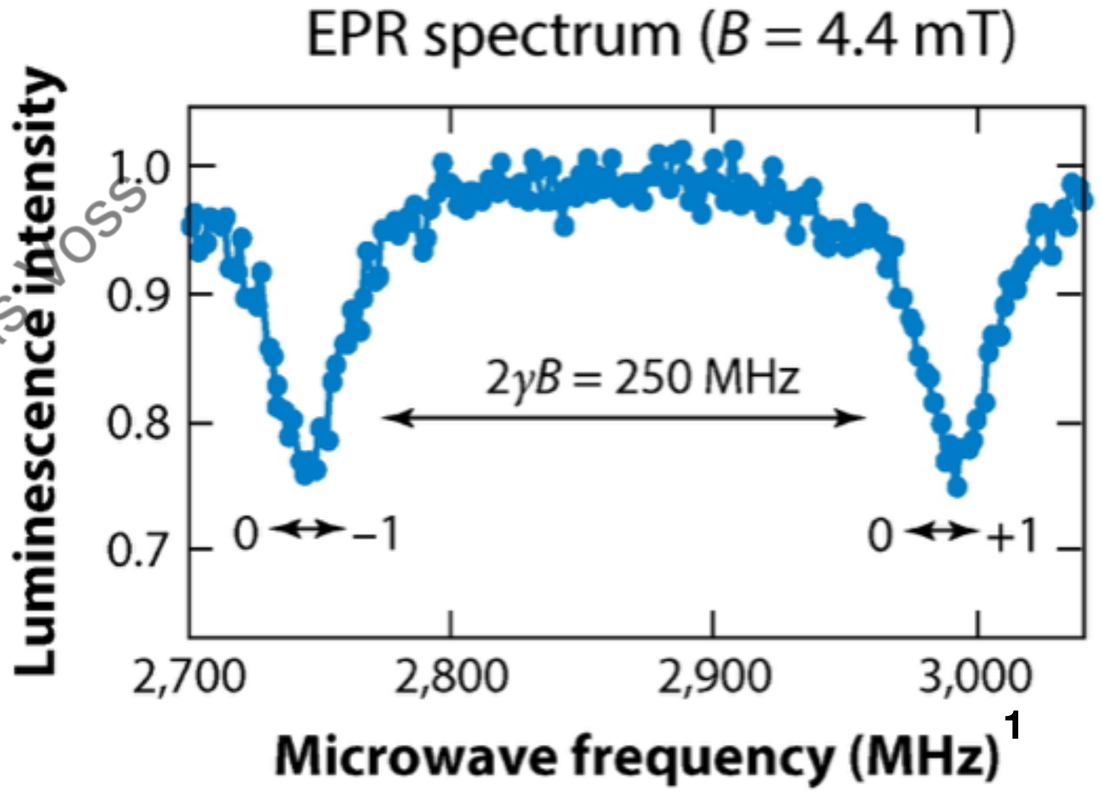
→ potential for quantum information

→ potential for quantum sensing

1 Herbschleb et al. *Ultra-long coherence times amongst room-temperature solid-state spins* In: Nature Communications (2019)

Motivation

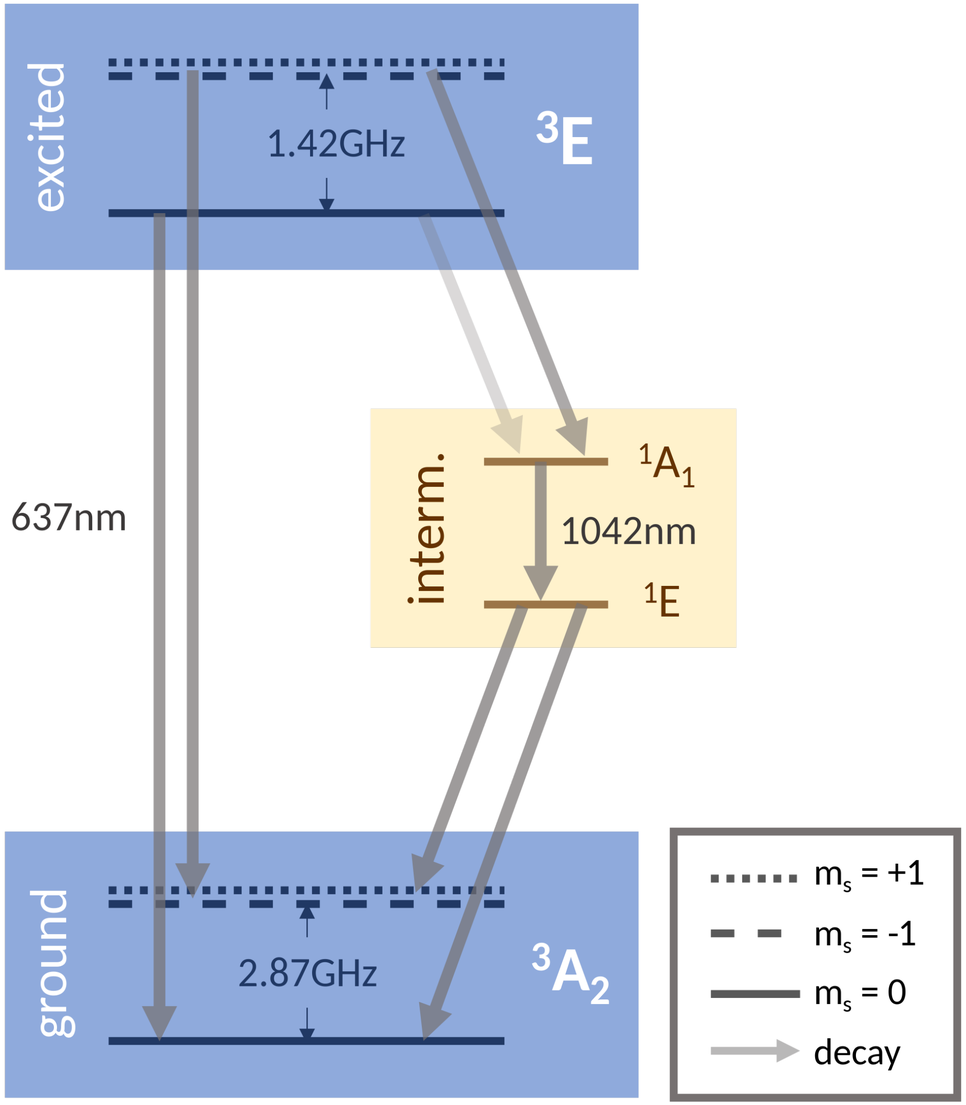




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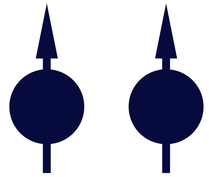
1 Romana Schirhagl et al. “Nitrogen-vacancy centers in diamond: nanoscale sensors for physics and biology”. In: Annual review of physical chemistry 65 (2014), pp. 83–105

Energy level structure



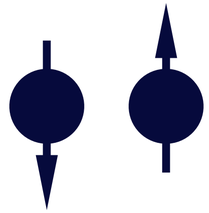
- excited-state triplet ^{3}E

$$m_s = +1$$



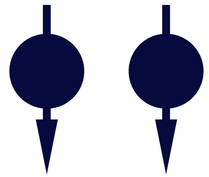
- Two intermediate-state singlets ^{1}A and ^{1}E

$$m_s = 0$$



- ground-state triplet ^{3}A

$$m_s = -1$$

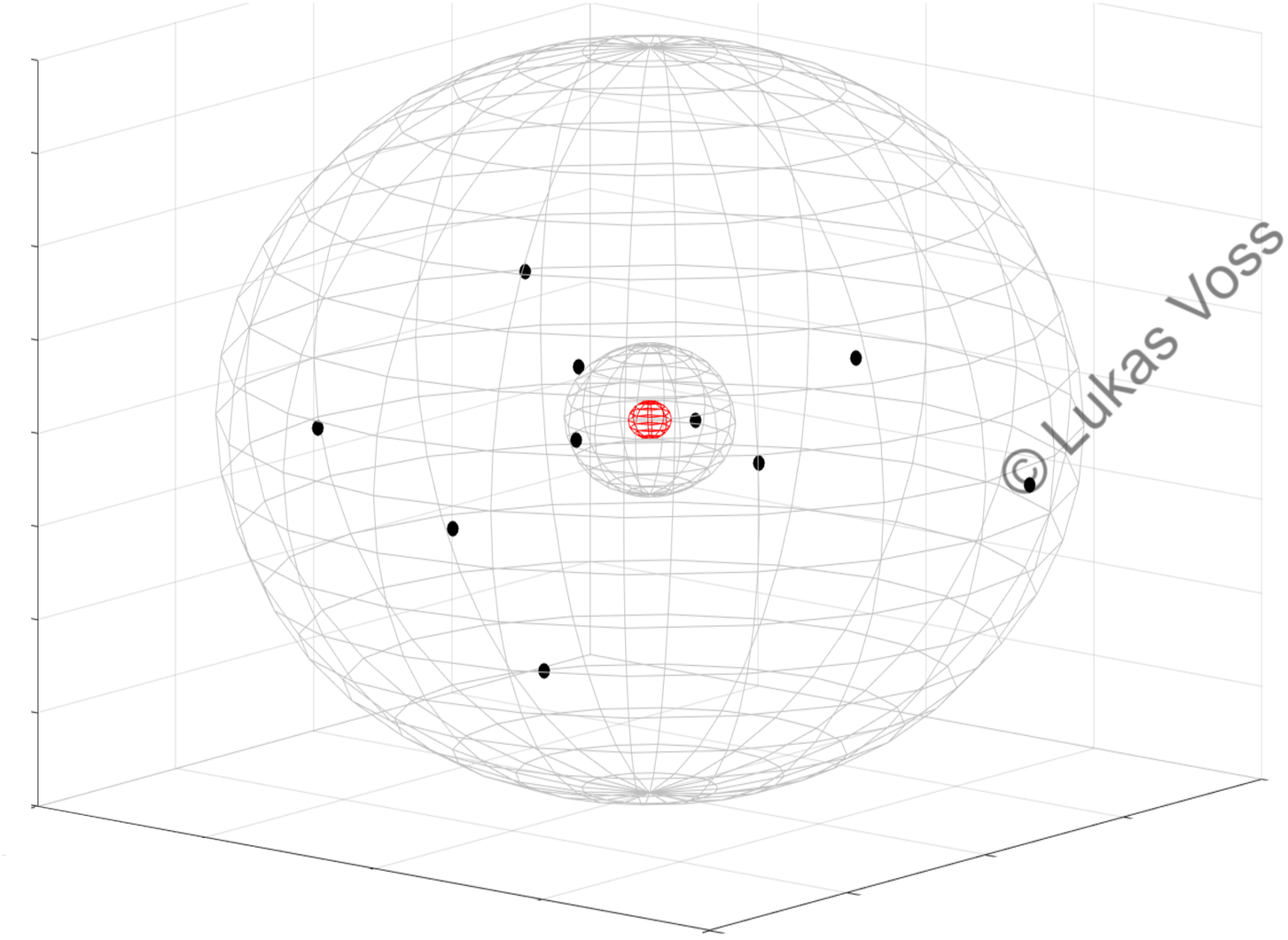


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The model

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The model



- One central NV spin

$$\rightarrow \quad S = 1$$

- Nuclear background spins of ^{13}C atoms in spherical shell

$$\rightarrow \quad I_j = \frac{1}{2}$$

- Pairwise interaction between S and I_j

The Hamiltonian

$$H = H_{\mathrm{NV}} + H_{\mathrm{BS}} + H_I$$

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- With the presence of a magnetic field $B = B_z$

$$H_{\mathrm{NV}} = D\,S_z^2 + \gamma_e\,B_z\,S_z$$

$$H_{\mathrm{BS}} = -\,\gamma_n\,B_z\,I_z$$

D: fine structure splitting

$\gamma_{e,n}$: gyromagnetic ratios

The Interaction Hamiltonian

$$H_I = \sum_{\alpha=1}^{N} \sum_{j \in \{x,y,z\}} \hat{S}_j \otimes \sum_{k \in \{x,y,z\}} T_{jk}^{(\alpha)} \cdot \hat{I}_k$$

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- N: number of background spins
- T: dipolar tensor
- $\hat{S}$: vector of spin-1 matrices
- $\hat{I}$: vector of spin-$\frac{1}{2}$ matrices

Pairwise interaction

- Magnetic dipole-dipole interaction[1]

$$T_{KL}^{(\alpha)} = \begin{cases} \gamma_e \gamma_n \hbar^2 \left(\dfrac{3\,(R_K^{(\alpha)})^2 - (R^{(\alpha)})^2}{(R^{(\alpha)})^5} \right) & K = L \\ \gamma_e \gamma_n \hbar^2 \left(\dfrac{3\,R_K^{(\alpha)} R_L^{(\alpha)}}{(R^{(\alpha)})^5} \right) & K \neq L \end{cases}$$

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- $\overrightarrow{R}$: connects the NV spin with nuclear spin α
- weak coupling regime due to $T_{KL}^{(\alpha)} \propto (R^{(\alpha)})^{-3}$

1 Alexander P Nizovtsev et al. “Non-flipping 13C spins near an NV center in diamond: hyperfine and spatial characteristics by density functional theory simulation of the C510 [NV] H252 cluster”. In: New Journal of Physics 20.2 (2018)

Monte Carlo simulation

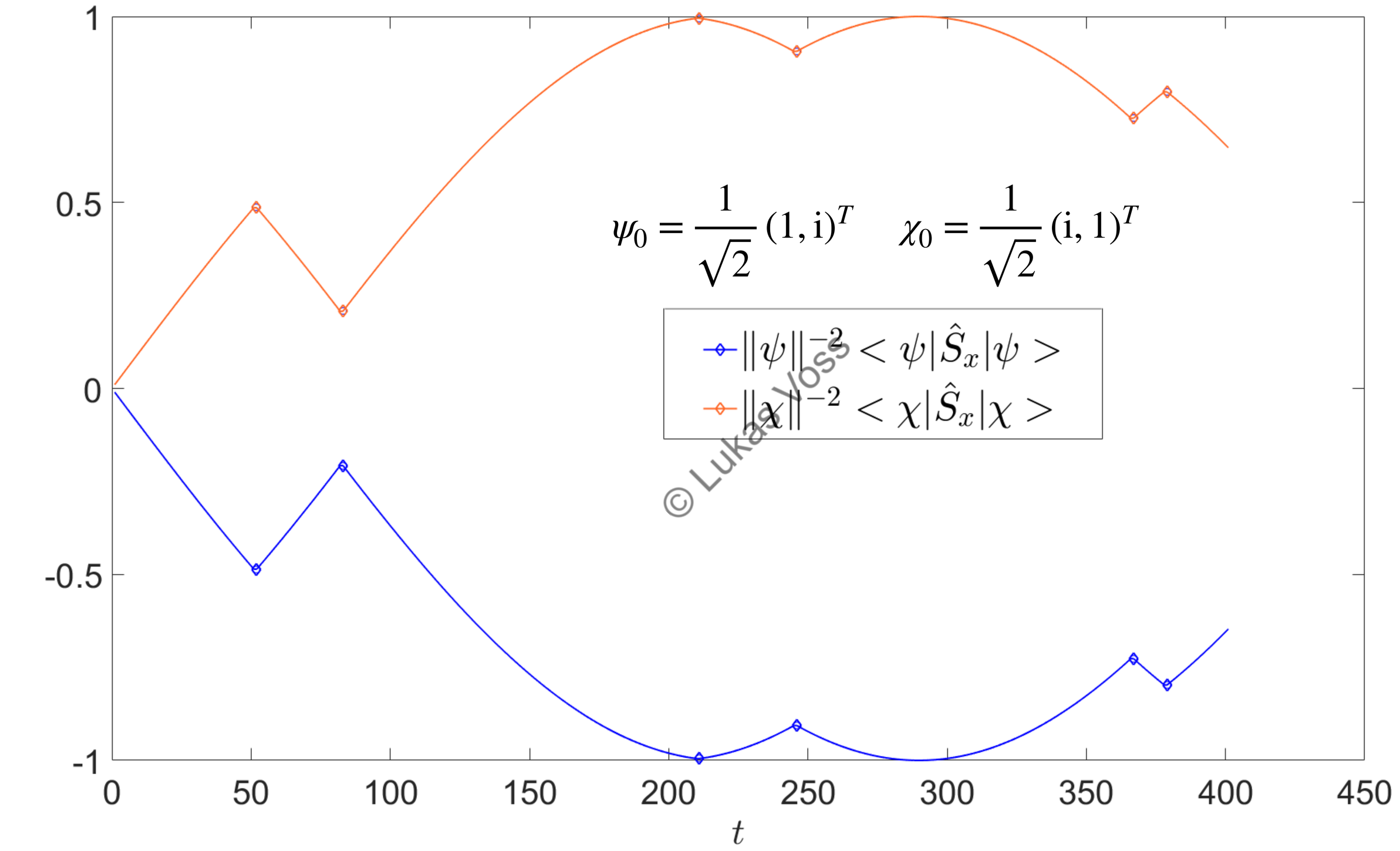


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- Modified quantum jump process as proposed by Breuer[1]

$$\left.\begin{aligned} \mathrm{d}\psi &= \frac{1}{2}\Gamma\,\psi(t)\,\mathrm{d}t + \left(\sqrt{\mathrm{i}}\,\frac{\|\psi(t)\|}{\|A\,\psi(t)\|}\,A - I\right)\psi(t)\,\mathrm{d}N \\ \mathrm{d}\chi &= \frac{1}{2}\Gamma\,\chi(t)\,\mathrm{d}t + \left(\sqrt{\mathrm{i}}\,\frac{\|\chi(t)\|}{\|B\,\chi(t)\|}\,B - I\right)\chi(t)\,\mathrm{d}N \end{aligned}\right\} \rightarrow \text{propagate to } t_{\max}$$

1 Heinz-Peter Breuer. “Exact quantum jump approach to open systems in bosonic and spin baths”. In: Physical Review A 69.2 (2004)


1
0.5
0
-0.5
-1
0
50
100
150
200
250
300
350
400
450
t
$\psi_0 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(1, \mathrm{i})^T \quad \chi_0 = \frac{1}{\sqrt{2}}(\mathrm{i}, 1)^T$
$\|\psi\|^{-2} < \psi|\hat{S}_x|\psi >$
$\|\chi\|^{-2} < \chi|\hat{S}_x|\chi >$
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Monte Carlo simulation

Idea: Propagate states not the density matrix

→ product state $\Phi = \psi \otimes \chi$

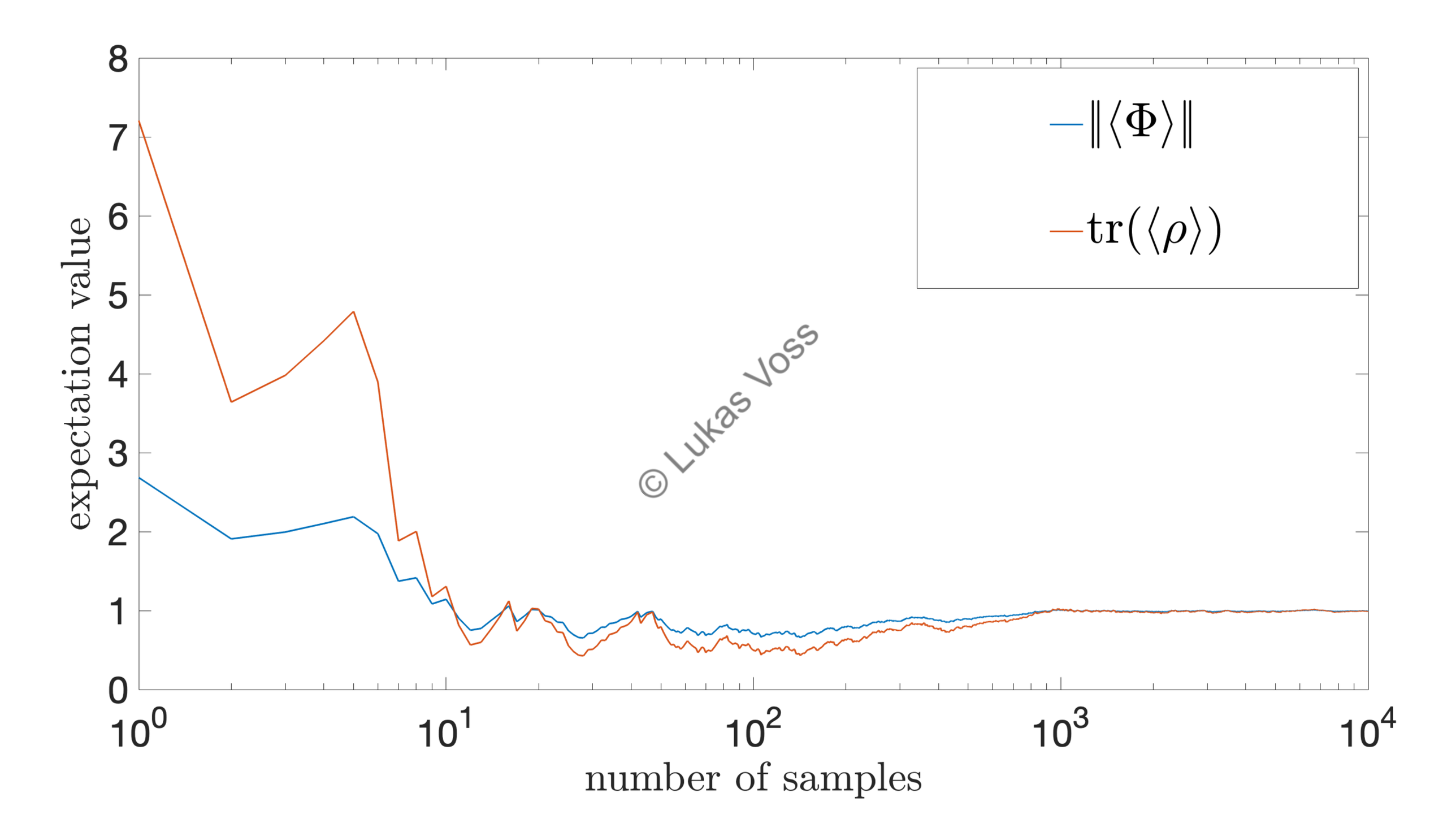
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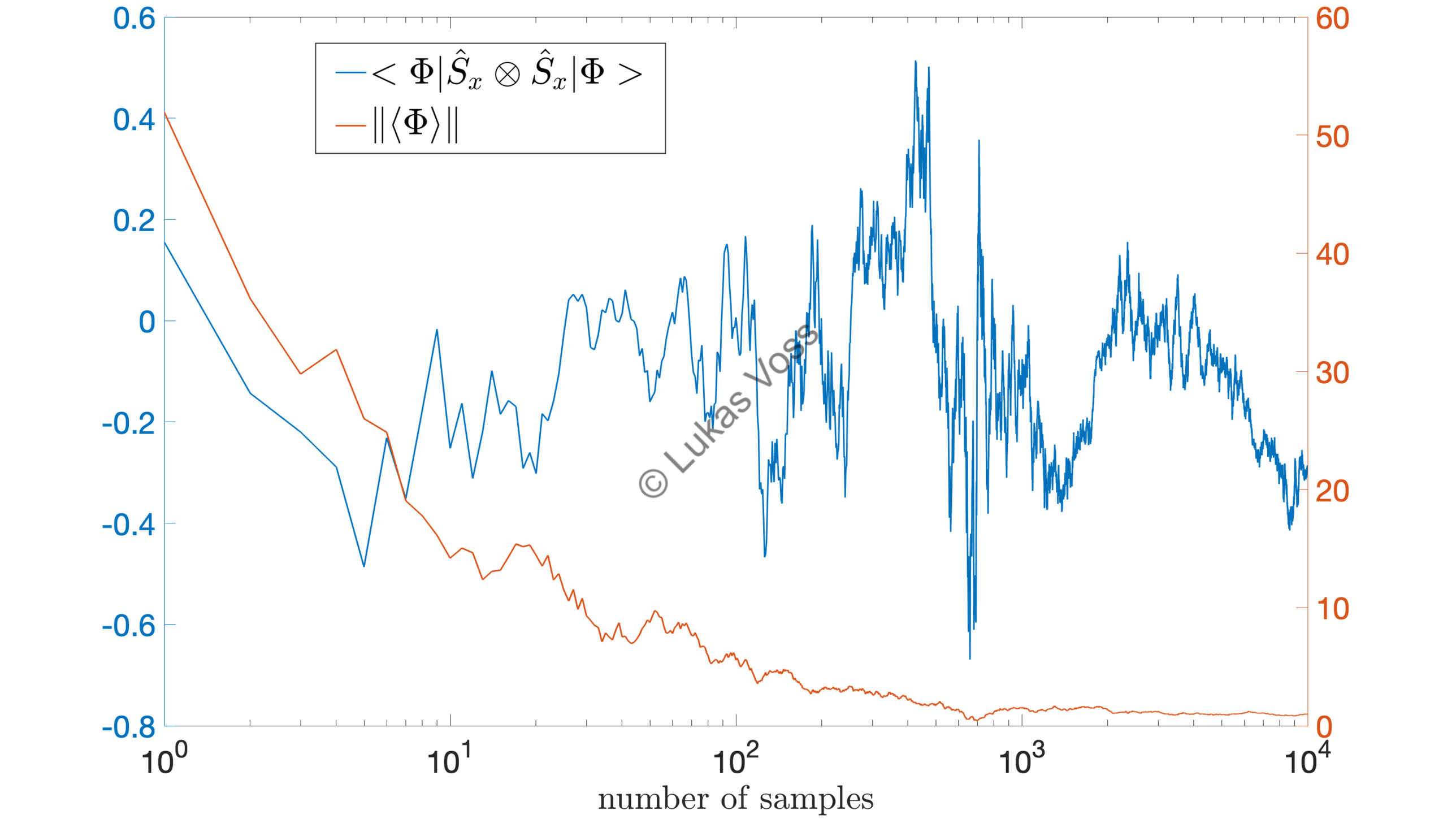
- The density matrix as the expectation value

$$\varrho = \mathbb{E}[|\Phi\rangle\langle\Phi|]$$

- $\mathrm{d}N$ is a differential of a Poisson increment for $\mathrm{d}t \to 0$

→ Waiting time τ between jumps is exponentially distributed


8
7
6
5
4
3
2
1
0
10^0
10^1
10^2
10^3
10^4
expectation value
number of samples
$\|\langle\Phi\rangle\|$
$\mathrm{tr}(\langle\rho\rangle)$
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$< \Phi | \hat{S}_x \otimes \hat{S}_x | \Phi >$
$\| \langle \Phi \rangle \|$
0.6
0.4
0.2
0
-0.2
-0.4
-0.6
-0.8
60
50
40
30
20
10
0
10^0
10^1
10^2
10^3
10^4
number of samples
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Jumps for dipole interaction

- Operators A and B for a given spin component j

$$A_j \in \{S_x, S_y, S_z\} \qquad B_{j,\alpha} = \sum_{k \in \{x,y,z\}} T^{(\alpha)}_{jk} \cdot \hat{I}_k$$

- Modified stochastic differential equations

$$\mathrm{d}\psi = \frac{1}{2} \sum_{\alpha=1}^{N} \Gamma_\alpha \, \psi(t) \, \mathrm{d}t + \left(\sqrt{\mathrm{i}} \frac{\|\psi(t)\|}{\|A_j \, \psi(t)\|} A_j - I \right) \psi(t) \, \mathrm{d}N_j$$

$$\mathrm{d}\chi_\alpha = \frac{1}{2} \Gamma_\alpha \, \chi_\alpha(t) \, \mathrm{d}t + \left(\sqrt{\mathrm{i}} \frac{\|\chi_\alpha(t)\|}{\|B_{j,\alpha} \, \chi_\alpha(t)\|} B_{j,\alpha} - I \right) \chi_\alpha(t) \, \mathrm{d}N_{j,\alpha}$$

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- Jump probability for spin α with spin component j $\qquad \Gamma_{j,\alpha} \, \mathrm{d}t = \dfrac{\|A_j \, \psi(t)\| \, \|B_{j,\alpha} \, \chi_\alpha(t)\|}{\|\psi(t)\| \, \|\chi_\alpha(t)\|} \mathrm{d}t$

Mean Field Pivot

$$\delta A_j = A_j - \frac{\langle\psi|A_j|\psi\rangle}{\langle\psi|\psi\rangle} \qquad \delta B_{j,\alpha} = B_{j,\alpha} - \frac{\langle\chi_\alpha|B_{j,\alpha}|\chi_\alpha\rangle}{\langle\chi_\alpha|\chi_\alpha\rangle}$$

$$\rightarrow \quad \Gamma = \Gamma(\delta A, \delta B)$$

- Adding correction terms

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$$\mathrm{d}\psi = \frac{1}{2}\sum_{\alpha=1}^{N}\Gamma_\alpha\,\psi(t)\,\mathrm{d}t + \mathrm{i}\sum_{j=1}^{3}A_j\,\langle B_j\rangle\,\psi(t)\,\mathrm{d}t + \left(\sqrt{\mathrm{i}}\,\frac{\|\psi(t)\|}{\|\delta A_j\,\psi(t)\|}\,\delta A_j - I\right)\psi(t)\,\mathrm{d}N_j$$

$$\mathrm{d}\chi_\alpha = \frac{1}{2}\Gamma_\alpha\,\chi(t)\,\mathrm{d}t + \mathrm{i}\sum_{j=1}^{3}\langle A_j\rangle\,B_{j,\alpha}\,\chi_\alpha(t)\,\mathrm{d}t + \left(\sqrt{\mathrm{i}}\,\frac{\|\chi_\alpha(t)\|}{\|\delta B_{j,\alpha}\,\chi_\alpha(t)\|}\,\delta B_{j,\alpha} - I\right)\chi_\alpha(t)\,\mathrm{d}N_{j,\alpha}$$

The jump process algorithm

- All probabilities for a jump are stored in a vector with $3N + 1$ entries

→ an index is drawn based on the probability distribution the vector forms

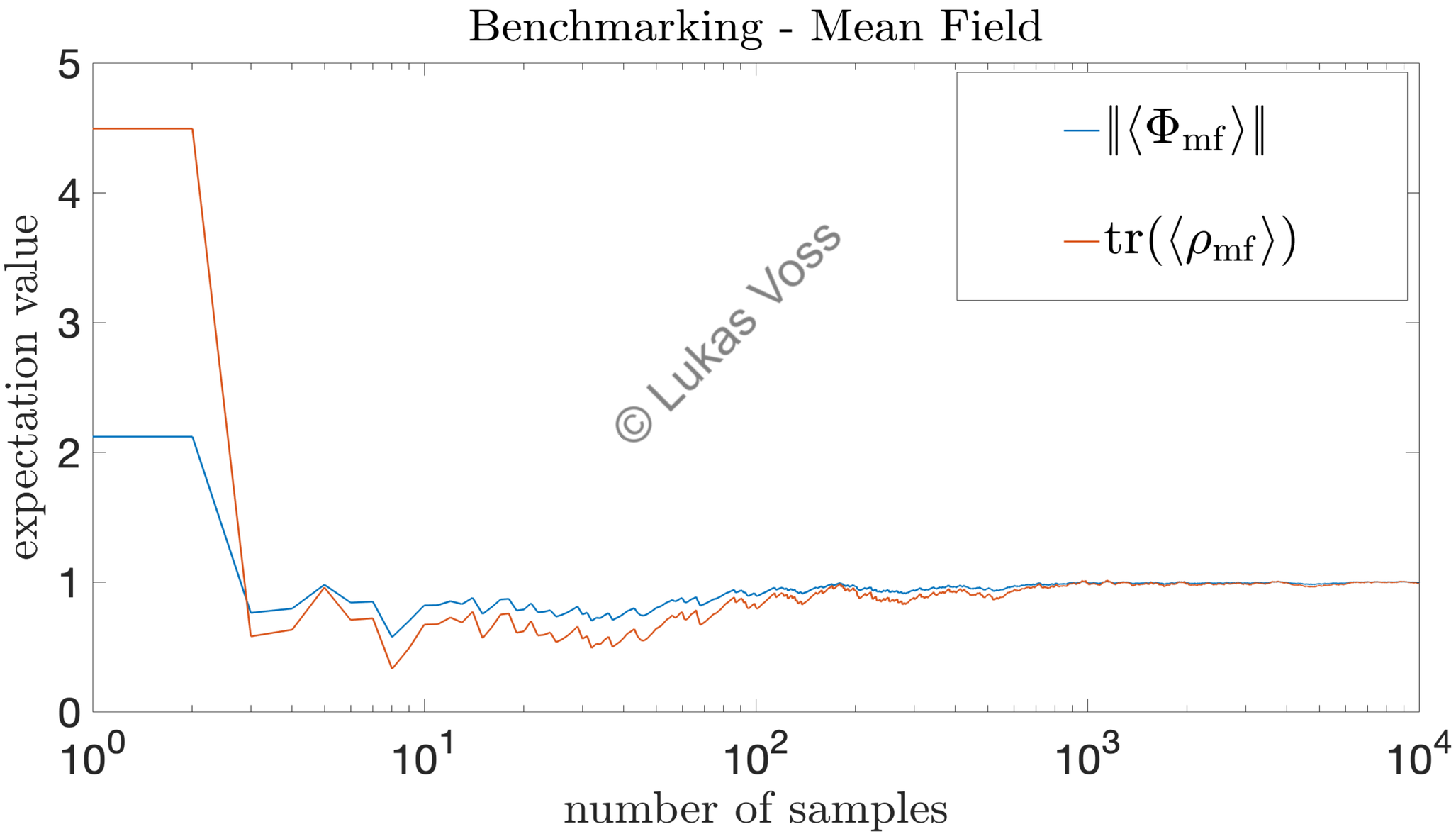
→ determine the background spin α and its spin component j

→ NV state ψ and the state of background spin χ_α perform an instantaneous jump

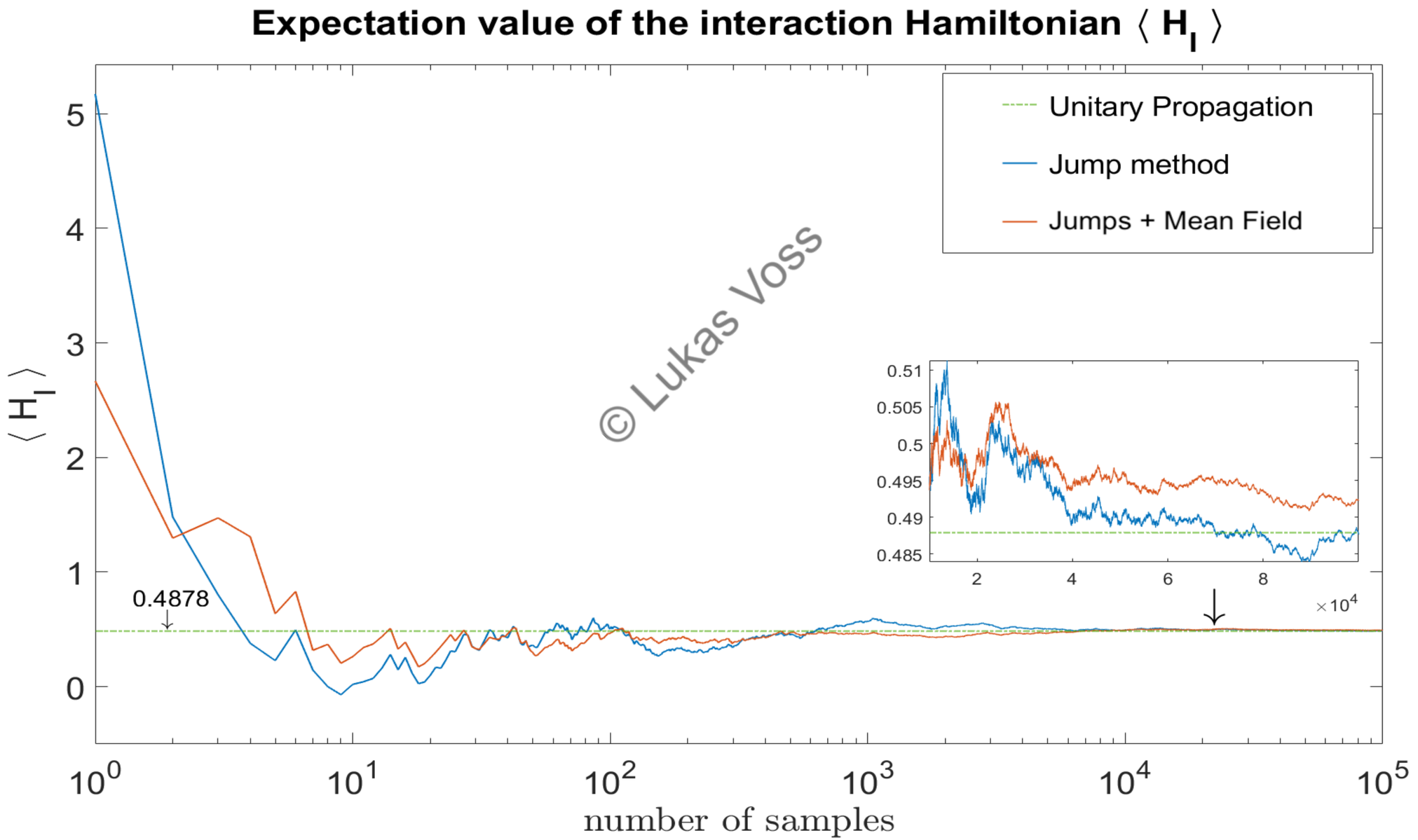
→ all other background spins propagate unitary and with their respective drift

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Evaluation of the model



Evaluation of the model



Summary

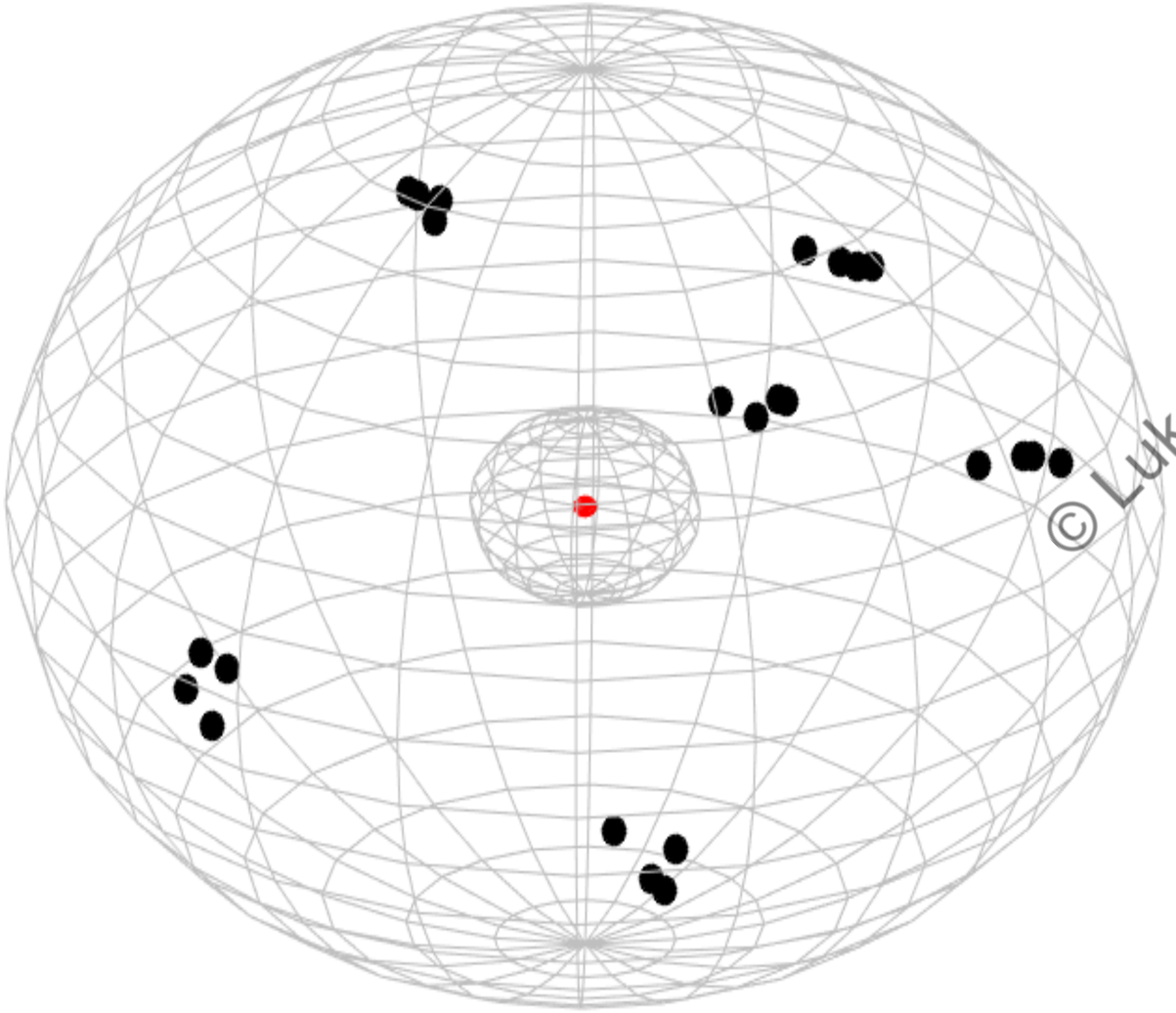
- Effect of Mean Field is not that strong for small spins S
- Product state Φ remains valid for each sample

→ Overcoming the curse of dimensionality

- Number of jumps decreases for higher spins S
- Further investigation needed for more reality-based settings

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Outlook and next steps



- **Clustered** nuclear background spins
- Introduce a pairwise dipolar interaction between spins within a cluster
- Pairwise interaction between clusters

Outlook and next steps

- Use a Kronecker Singular Value Decomposition (KP-SVD) for the interaction matrix

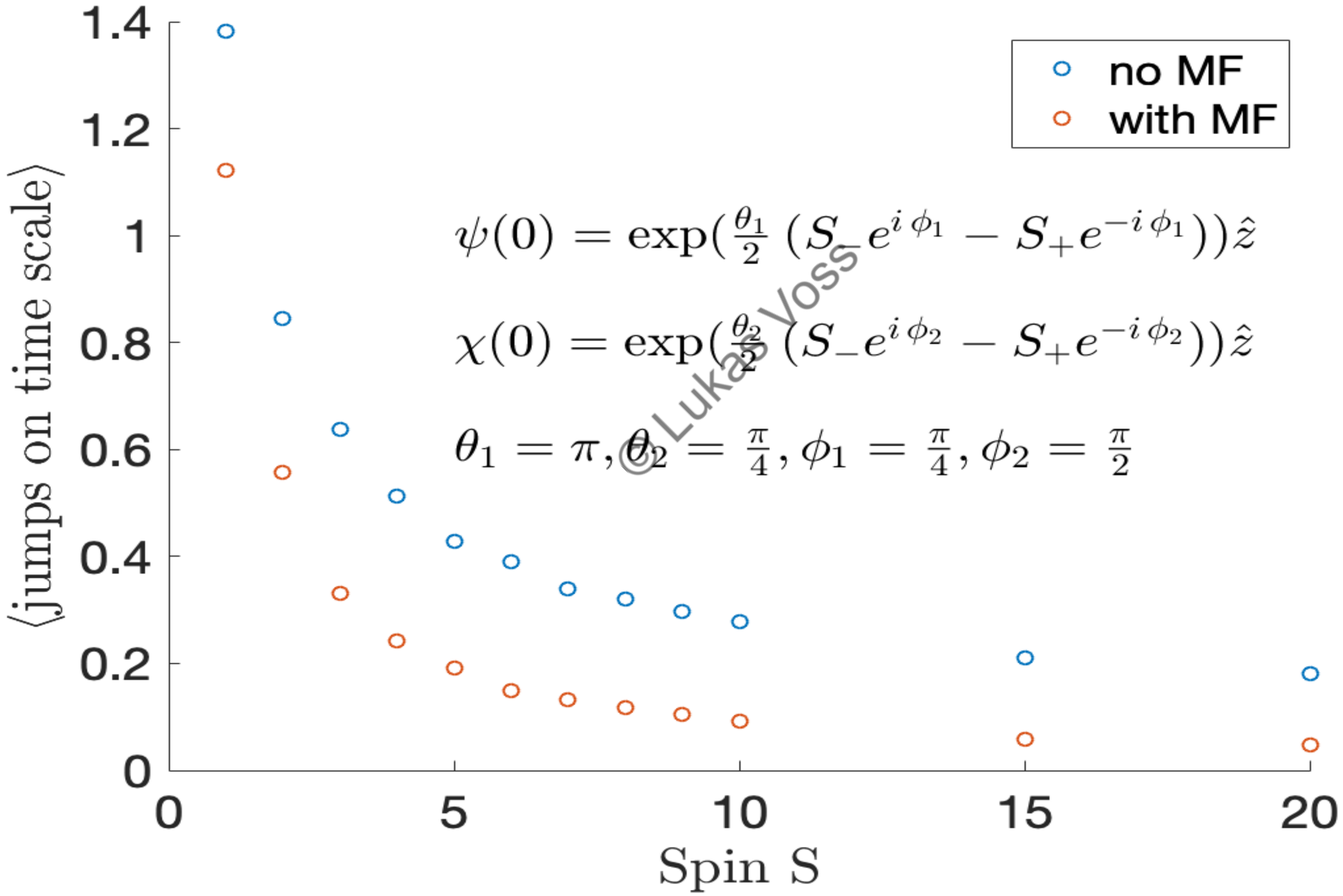
$$T^{(\alpha,\alpha')} = \sum_{j=1}^{\mathrm{rank}(T)} \tilde{\sigma} B_j \otimes C_j$$

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→ Investigate how many singular values are necessary for a more efficient simulation

- Get in touch with Prof. Jelezko's group to get detailed information about experimental parameters to run a simulation linked to real world properties

Appendix



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